Feedback Systems in Product-Based Companies

Research, Best Practices, and Implementation Insights

Internship Research Report | Prepared by: Siddharth, WNS Intern Trainee | October 2026

1. Introduction and Objectives

Product-based companies receive feedback from many sources: bug reports, feature requests, support conversations, satisfaction ratings and analytics. Feedback only creates value when it is collected in a usable form, organised, assigned to an owner, acted upon and measured. This report studies how established platforms approach each of these stages.

Objectives

- Understand how leading platforms collect, categorise, prioritise and track feedback.
- Identify the distinctive strength each platform contributes.
- Consolidate the findings into a common workflow and practical lessons for enterprise applications.

Sources and conventions. The Microsoft, Intercom and Atlassian sections are based on the intern's research notes on each platform's official documentation. Capabilities described as "documented" come from those notes or, for Salesforce, from the official source named below; sections marked "Recommendation" are suggested design practices, not platform features. Workflows shown are conceptual and do not claim to describe any company's internal process.

> *Source note: The Salesforce section is based on Salesforce's official Feedback Management Developer Guide, reviewed separately because no Salesforce research notes were available. That guide is developer-focused and says little about prioritisation or issue tracking, so Salesforce is described only for what it documents.*

2. Overview of the Feedback Systems

The platforms solve related but different problems. Keeping their roles distinct avoids treating every kind of feedback as the same thing.

Platform	What it is	Type of feedback emphasised	Question it answers
Microsoft Feedback Hub	Windows application where users report problems, suggest improvements and share experiences.	User-initiated, structured problem reports, suggestions and compliments.	What problems are users reporting?
Intercom	Customer service and communication platform with in-app messaging, surveys, tagging and reporting.	Contextual in-app feedback, support conversations and satisfaction ratings (CSAT).	How are users experiencing the product?
Atlassian Jira Product Discovery	Tool for product teams to collect ideas and insights, evaluate opportunities and prioritise work.	Product-level ideas backed by evidence; not a primary collection channel.	What should we improve or build next?
Salesforce Feedback Management	Surveys capability on Salesforce with APIs, Apex classes and standard objects for building, sending and managing surveys.	Survey-based feedback, including in-app surveys, to gauge satisfaction and opinions of products or services.	How satisfied are respondents, and what do they think of our products or services?

Four concepts that should not be confused:

- **User-reported feedback** (Feedback Hub): a user deliberately submits a problem or suggestion.
- **In-app contextual feedback** (Intercom, and Salesforce in-app surveys): the application asks a relevant question without sending the user elsewhere.

- **Customer satisfaction measurement** (Intercom CSAT; Salesforce surveys): a rating or survey response of an experience, which is not the same as product accuracy or quality.
- **Product prioritisation** (Jira Product Discovery): deciding which opportunities to pursue, which is separate from collecting feedback and from fixing individual defects.

3. Common Feedback-Management Workflow

Across the four platforms, the researched practices fit one end-to-end workflow. Each stage is explained once below, with the platform that illustrates it.

Stage	What happens	Platform evidence (documented)
1. Collect	Feedback is captured through a user-initiated form or a prompt triggered in context. Concise titles, clear descriptions and supporting evidence make reports actionable.	Feedback Hub: summary, details, type, category, attachments. Intercom: event- and rule-based surveys. Salesforce: surveys with a wide range of question types, including in-app surveys.
2. Categorise	Each item is typed (problem, suggestion, compliment) and given a category or tag so it can be directed and searched.	Feedback Hub: category and subcategory. Intercom: tags such as bugs, feature requests, complaints, positive feedback.
3. Group duplicates	Related reports are linked so repeated problems are seen as one issue with accumulated evidence.	Feedback Hub: search first, upvote or add similar feedback. Intercom: specific tags for particular bugs or features.
4. Route and assign	The item reaches the responsible team, and a named owner is accountable for it.	Feedback Hub: shared with relevant feature teams. Intercom: tags and workflows make feedback available to the right people.
5. Prioritise	Teams compare reach, impact, effort and confidence rather than counting reports alone.	Jira Product Discovery: custom fields, formulas, sorting, frameworks such as RICE.
6. Resolve and track	Approved work becomes delivery tasks; status is updated and the outcome is communicated.	Feedback Hub: statuses such as “More details needed” and “Changes made”. Jira Product Discovery: ideas linked to Jira epics or tasks.
7. Analyse and measure	Trends, satisfaction and outcomes show whether the change solved the original problem.	Intercom: tags, CSAT reports and trends. Salesforce: continuous survey feedback shows where to invest or change course. Jira Product Discovery: checking the outcome after delivery.

Two cautions apply to the whole workflow. A submitted report is **not a guarantee** of a fix: teams may ask for more detail, treat the behaviour as intentional, or decline a suggestion. Also, a **tag is not ownership**: assigning a category does not record who is responsible, by when, or how the issue was resolved.

4. Key Practices and Distinctive Features of Each Platform

4.1 Microsoft Feedback Hub: structured, user-initiated reporting

- **Three feedback types:** suggestions, problems and compliments, so praise is captured alongside defects.
- **Search before submitting:** users can upvote a suggestion or add their experience to an existing problem report, which reduces duplicates. The available action depends on the feedback type.
- **Structured submission:** a concise summary, details, category and subcategory, and optional attachments such as screenshots, files and recordings of reproduction steps. Problem reports can indicate that the issue is blocking the user’s work.
- **Community signals and visibility:** sorting by Trending, Recent or Upvotes, plus search and filtering. Upvotes show interest but do not determine technical severity.

- **Status and privacy:** statuses tell users whether more details are needed or changes have been made. Diagnostic data depends on privacy settings, and for public feedback, attachments and diagnostics are shared with Microsoft rather than publicly.

Distinctive strength: a clear, user-facing path from report to status. **Boundary:** it is a Windows user feedback channel, not an HR or employee-performance platform.

4.2 Intercom: contextual feedback and pattern recognition

- **In-app surveys:** configured to appear based on events, page rules, dates and audience conditions, with settings to limit how often users receive them.
- **Event-based triggers:** tracked events (for example, completing a purchase) determine when a user is asked. Intercom's guidance suggests asking after a user has tried a feature several times, while the experience is fresh. Real-time triggering is not identical on every platform; mobile survey documentation describes limits.
- **Conditional questions:** a short first question, with a follow-up only when more detail is needed (for example, after a "Difficult" rating).
- **CSAT:** users rate support conversations and can add comments; managers review rating reports to find ways to improve support quality.
- **Tagging and routing:** conversations are tagged (bugs, feature requests, complaints, positive feedback) so recurring issues can be searched and shared with the relevant teams; workflows and automation support routing.

Distinctive strength: asking the right question at the right moment, then turning individual comments into patterns through tags. **Boundary:** satisfaction ratings measure experience, not correctness or quality.

4.3 Atlassian Jira Product Discovery: from feedback to prioritised decisions

- **Ideas:** a product-level record for a problem, opportunity, solution or feature request, with a description, custom fields, comments, insights and links to delivery work.
- **Insights:** evidence attached to an idea, such as customer quotes, support tickets, analytics, research findings and stakeholder messages, with links, impact ratings and labels.
- **Prioritisation:** custom fields, formulas, sorting and frameworks such as RICE (Reach × Impact × Confidence ÷ Effort) let teams compare ideas consistently. RICE is one option, not a requirement.
- **Views and roadmaps:** list, board, matrix and timeline views show different fields to different audiences. A roadmap communicates current plans and may change as evidence changes.
- **Delivery links:** a prioritised idea can be linked to Jira epics or tasks, giving product teams visibility of implementation progress.

Distinctive strength: separating what to build and why (product discovery) from how to build it (engineering delivery). **Boundary:** it is for discovery and prioritisation, not a replacement for every bug tracker or support system.

The documents distinguish four levels of record: **feedback** (a single report), **insight** (evidence confirming a pattern), **idea** (the product-level problem or opportunity) and **delivery task** (the engineering work).

4.4 Salesforce Feedback Management: extensible, survey-based feedback

- **Purpose:** Salesforce describes surveys as a way to gather continuous feedback, understand satisfaction levels and gain insight into products or services, then invest where feedback is positive or change course where it is negative.
- **In-app surveys:** built with the Feedback Management Response APIs, so participants do not have to switch to another application. Salesforce states that these surveys can match a company's branding, which it says helps response rates.
- **Developer building blocks:** Connect REST APIs to build surveys, Apex classes to send survey invitations, REST APIs to translate surveys, standard invocable actions, and a documented object model with standard objects.

- **Question variety, translation and personalisation:** surveys support a wide range of question types, can be translated for a global audience and can be personalised.
- **Participant identity:** the business APIs distinguish surveys for authenticated participants from surveys for unauthenticated participants.

Distinctive strength: a programmable survey platform whose in-app surveys keep users inside the application. **Boundary:** the documentation reviewed concerns building and sending surveys; it does not describe prioritisation or issue tracking, so those capabilities are not attributed to it here. Salesforce's own example use case is employee feedback on an onboarding process, which shows surveys are not limited to product feedback.

5. Comparative Table of the Platforms

Aspect	Microsoft Feedback Hub	Intercom	Jira Product Discovery	Salesforce Feedback Mgmt
Primary purpose	Collect problem reports, suggestions and compliments.	Communicate with users, collect contextual feedback, measure satisfaction.	Evaluate opportunities and prioritise product work.	Build and send surveys to gauge satisfaction and opinions.
Who initiates	The user, who opens the tool.	The application, via events and rules.	The product team.	The organisation, via survey invitations or in-app surveys.
Collection method	Structured form with type, category and attachments.	In-app surveys, messages, conversations, CSAT.	Ideas and insights added from other sources.	Surveys with varied question types; in-app via Response APIs.
Categorisation	Category and subcategory at submission.	Tags, general and specific.	Custom fields on ideas.	Not covered in the documentation reviewed.
Duplicate handling	Search first; upvote or add similar feedback.	Specific tags group reports.	Evidence attached to one idea.	Not covered in the documentation reviewed.
Prioritisation signals	Upvotes, trending, filtering (interest only).	Tag trends and rating reports.	Impact, effort, RICE, other scores.	Not covered in the documentation reviewed.
Ownership and tracking	Shared with feature teams; status shown to users.	Tags and workflows direct feedback to teams.	Ideas linked to Jira delivery work.	Not covered in the documentation reviewed.
Distinctive strength	Clear structure and visible status.	Right question at the right moment; pattern detection.	Evidence-based prioritisation linked to delivery.	Programmable, translatable surveys that keep users in-app.
Limitation or boundary	Not a promise of a fix; not an HR tool.	Satisfaction is not accuracy; mobile trigger limits.	Not a complete bug tracker or support system.	Documentation reviewed is survey- and developer-focused.

6. Best Practices and Lessons for Enterprise Applications

> *Recommendation: this section draws practical lessons from the documented capabilities above. These are suggested practices, not features claimed for any platform.*

6.1 Practices by stage

Area	Recommended practice
Collection	Offer a permanent "report an issue" option and add short, targeted surveys at selected moments. Keep forms structured but brief, and let users attach evidence (screenshots, error messages, identifiers). Limit survey frequency to avoid fatigue, and log routine technical errors automatically instead of showing pop-ups. Prefer in-app surveys so users stay in context, and consider translation and personalisation for varied audiences.
Categorisation	Classify by the problem being reported, and store the submitter's role separately. Use broad categories plus specific issue tags, and link recurring reports to one underlying issue. Treat feedback types differently: a dispute about a result is a quality-review matter, not automatically a software defect.

Area	Recommended practice
Prioritisation	Do not rely on report counts or upvotes alone; weigh severity, business impact, reach, effort and confidence. Handle critical defects, security issues and mandatory requirements through a separate severity-based escalation, outside RICE-style scoring.
Ownership and resolution	Record an owner, status, response target where appropriate, and resolution details for every item. Define explicit statuses (for example: New, Under review, Assigned, In progress, Resolved, Closed, Rejected with a reason) and tell submitters the outcome.
Analysis	Track average resolution time, repeat-issue rate, satisfaction and trends by module or workflow step, and analyse them by issue type so easy fixes do not hide critical ones. Measure satisfaction alongside independent quality metrics, and avoid using raw complaint counts as a performance score for individuals.
Privacy and access	Give each role access only to what it needs, and keep each client's data separate. Decide whether respondents must be authenticated, since identified and anonymous feedback carry different privacy and follow-up implications. Reference sensitive items by identifier instead of copying them, and apply retention and access rules to attachments and logs.

6.2 Useful fields for a feedback record

Combining the four platforms, a general feedback record would benefit from: unique ID; submitter and role; feedback type; category and tags; description and evidence; related item, batch or account identifiers; severity and priority; assigned team and owner; status; and created and resolved timestamps.

7. Conclusion and Recommendations

The four platforms each cover a different part of the feedback lifecycle. Feedback Hub shows how to collect structured reports and keep users informed of status. Intercom shows how to ask for feedback in context and detect recurring problems through tagging. Jira Product Discovery shows how to convert evidence into prioritised, traceable product decisions. Salesforce shows how a programmable, in-app survey capability can gather continuous feedback on satisfaction and opinions. Together they indicate that a feedback system should not end when a report is submitted; it should trace each item from source to owner, decision and outcome.

Recommendations

- Combine user-initiated reporting with selective, event-triggered prompts rather than choosing only one.
- Use a consistent taxonomy of types, categories and tags, with duplicate linking, from the start.
- Separate prioritisation of improvements from urgent severity escalation.
- Assign a named owner and explicit status to every item, and communicate outcomes.
- Keep satisfaction, quality and accuracy as distinct measurements.
- Design role-based access and privacy controls before collecting evidence.
- Use surveys to measure experience and satisfaction, and pair them with a structured issue-tracking and prioritisation process, since the surveys alone do not resolve issues.

References

Microsoft, Intercom and Atlassian links are retained from the research notes; Salesforce links come from Salesforce's official developer documentation. Links have not been re-verified for this report.

Microsoft Feedback Hub

- Microsoft Support (Windows)
- Feedback Hub app in the Microsoft Store
- Send feedback using Feedback Hub (Microsoft Support)

Intercom

- Intercom website

- Getting feedback on product features
- Automatically triggering surveys
- Tagging support requests and bugs
- Measuring customer satisfaction with conversation ratings

Atlassian Jira Product Discovery

- Jira Product Discovery website
- Ideas overview
- Insights overview
- Getting started guide
- Linking ideas to Jira delivery work
- Views and visualization

Salesforce Feedback Management

- Introduction to Salesforce Feedback Management (Developer Guide)
- Creation of surveys using the Feedback Management Response APIs
- Salesforce Feedback Management Developer Guide (PDF, Spring ’25)